

OUTLIERS

You Stopped Feeding It

Part 3 of 4 · Getting what you know into it
without sitting down and typing.

Why have you stopped putting things into it?

It works. You have seen it work. And you have not added anything to it for a fortnight.

YOU WILL RECOGNISE SOME OF THIS

- You meant to write up that client call and never did.
- The sharpest thing you said all month was said out loud on a call, and it exists nowhere at all now.
- You have a folder of reports and books you have never opened twice.
- Adding to it has started to feel like homework.
- You know it would be more useful if you fed it, and you still are not feeding it.

WHY IT HAPPENS

Think of the last really good call you had. Forty minutes with a client, and somewhere in the middle you explained exactly why their last supplier let them down and what you do differently. It was the best version of that argument you have ever made.

Write down where that exists now. It does not. You will make that argument again next month, from scratch, slightly worse, and you will not notice that is what you are doing.

The reason is that there is only one way in, and it is you, typing.

That is admin. Not difficult, not long - just admin, which is the thing every one of these systems eventually loses to. Nobody abandons a second brain because they stopped believing in it. They abandon it because keeping it fed became one more job.

And the material that never gets in is the material worth the most. Almost everything valuable in a service business is said, not written: on a call, in a conversation, in an answer you gave a client off the top of your head. It is gone in a fortnight and there is no copy anywhere.

What fixes it

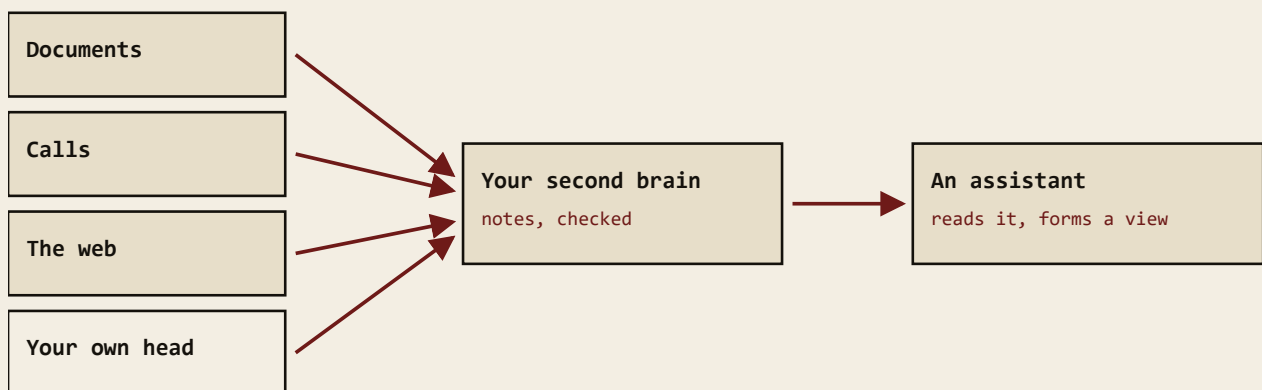
Four ways in, matching the four ways material actually reaches a business.

Long documents - contracts, reports, books. Read a chunk at a time, and read twice. The first time it writes down what the author actually said. The second time, separately, it works out what that means for your business. Both at once and you get a summary of the bits you already agreed with.

Spoken word - a recording becomes text on your own machine (a **transcript**), and that text becomes the four things worth keeping: what was decided, what was promised and by whom, what was learned, and who was mentioned.

The web - one click saves a page as text with its source and date already filled in, so a page that changes later cannot quietly change what you believed.

Your own head - decisions and the reasoning behind them, what you charge and why, what you refuse. This is the one nobody else can supply.



The fourth is the one nobody else can supply, and the one everybody skips.

FOUR WAYS IN, ONE PLACE THEY ALL LAND

WHY THIS WAY AND NOT ANOTHER

- **Volume beats tidiness, by a long way.** A messy system with four hundred real documents in it is worth more than a beautiful one with twelve. You cannot find a connection in material you never loaded.
- **Organising is the trap.** It feels like progress and produces nothing. The instruction for the first fortnight is genuinely: put more in than feels sensible, and tidy none of it.
- **Captured on the source's terms first.** A single pass that reads and applies at the same time always collapses into a summary of things you already agreed with, and the parts that disagree with you are the only parts capable of changing anything.
- **Your own material is what makes it sound like you.** Everything else in here is other people's. Skip the fourth way in and you have built a very good library of somebody else's thinking.

Do this

One command. It asks you a few questions so what you get is yours, then does the work.

Type these into a terminal, one line at a time, pressing enter after each. Not into Claude - these are instructions for your computer.

```
git clone https://github.com/OUTLIERS-ai/outliers-sb-03-capture
cd outliers-sb-03-capture
python install.py
```

This needs Parts 1 and 2 already done. It fills your system faster than you can read it, which is exactly why the check has to be underneath it first.

WHAT IT ASKS YOU, AND WHY

QUESTION	WHAT IT CHANGES
What do you record calls with?	Picks the route from a recording to text. If nothing yet, it sets up the one that runs on your own machine and uploads nothing.
Install the assistants that read what arrives?	Adds the ones that handle documents, books, calls and research. They can be added later without redoing anything.
Anything it should never read?	Folders named here are left alone by everything in this part.

WHAT YOU END UP WITH

One command you will use constantly - it takes anything at all and works out where it goes without asking you to choose - and five helpers with one job each:

HELPER	WHAT IT HANDLES
the archivist	Contracts, proposals, reports. Flags anything committing you to a date.
the librarian	Books and courses, on the author's own terms.
the scribe	Anything spoken - a call, a voice note.
the researcher	The web, saved with its sources and dated.
the curator	Notices when two of your notes disagree.

What you will notice

Put more in than feels sensible, and tidy none of it.

For the first stretch, the only job is volume. Feed it the things you have never got round to: the last few client calls, the proposals, what you actually charge, the two books you keep recommending.

Then ask it the question that tests the whole thing: **what do you now know about my business that I never told you directly?** A thin answer means it needs more material. An answer that surprises you means it has crossed from a filing cabinet into something worth having.

IF YOU ALREADY HAVE SOMETHING LIKE THIS

If material is already flowing in, the test is whether any of it is yours rather than other people's. Ask it for everything it holds on how you price, what you refuse, and what you have changed your mind about. Most systems come back nearly empty on all three, and that gap is what this is really for.

WHAT IT STILL DOES NOT DO

You now have several assistants able to write into the thing everything else stands on, and sooner or later one of them will be pointed at something that reaches another human being.

Nothing decides what runs when, nothing limits them, and nothing stops one checking its own work and passing it.

NEXT: PART 4 • OPERATIONS

What runs when, what is not allowed out without you seeing it, and how to tell the difference between a system with nothing to report and one that has broken.

WORDS USED HERE

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS
Assistant	A single-purpose helper with its own written instructions and permission to use particular things and nothing else.
Transcript	The text of something spoken, produced on your own machine so the recording never leaves it.